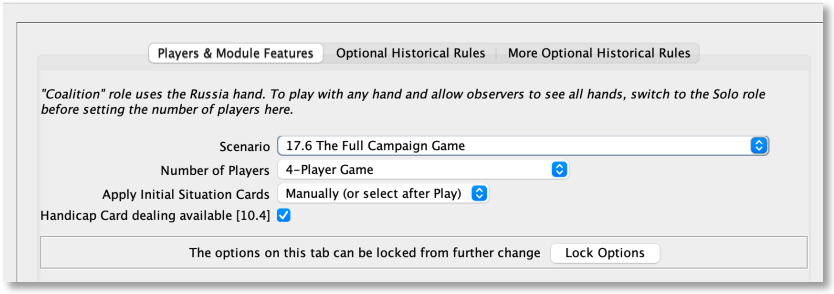
Congress of Vienna Vassal Module

Starting a new game

1. **Launch the game**. Start the game as you normally would in Vassal.
2. **Choose Your Side**,
   - If you're playing a 2- or 3-player game, the player controlling multiple powers should select *Coalition*. This player will be referred to as the *Coalition* throughout the game.
   - If you're playing a solo game, choose *Solo*, to gain access to all Powers' windows.
   - Otherwise, just select your designated power.
3. **Initial Setup.** There are no scenarios to select during game start. This is selected after the game launches using the *Scenario Options* Dialog.

Scenario Options

When the game is started a scenario options dialog pane opens.



- **Players & Module Features:**
  - *Scenario* is used to select which, among the six detailed in the games Playbook, scenario to set up, or to get a blank map to set up by yourself or by loading a game
  - *Number of players* is used to decide which type of game to play. Either 4-player, 3-player, 2-players or Solo CDG. Note that you can always play any of the game types as Solo, giving you access to all player hands.
  - *Apply Initial Situation* Cards is used to have the game automatically applying a Situation Card as soon as it is drawn. If you prefer to apply it yourself, either by resolving the instructions manually, or by invoking the Situation Card's context menu, chose *Manually*.
  - *Handicap Cards.* Check this box if you want to be able to deal Handicap cards.
- **Optional Historical Rules:**
  - Is tab is used to state which optional rules, such as *Landing in Holland* or The *Tactical Battle Matrix* is used in the game.
  - Note, for Historical Rules, explicitly selecting them is usually mandatory as the needed game pieces and setup is not performed otherwise.
- **More Optional Historical Rules:**
  - This is a list of optional rules that are published on Inside GMT and not available in the printed version. Selecting which of these rules to use is informative only, no specific alterations to the game is made.

You can always revisit the options screen by choosing File => Scenario Options in the Game menu.

The Toolbar Buttons


Undo: This is VASSAL's standard "undo" function to take back moves.


Forward: This is VASSAL's standard "Forward" function to move through a play log.


Server Controls: This is VASSAL's standard function to show/hide server connections pane


Retire: This is VASSAL's standard "retire" function to switch between player sides or become an observer.


Player Aid: This opens a window with player aid information, including the printed player aid sheet, the rule- & playbook backsides plus plenty of additional charts and info.


Additional Markers: This opens a window with additional markers that are not available on the board, for example Additional Resources and US Military Operation.


Sequence of Play: This button opens a window with the sequence of play. In addition, this includes a ruler to mark the current position in the sequence and direct access to specific game functions related to the sequence, for example card dealing


Card Window: This opens the card window where you will find the gamecard decks such as the deck of situation cards and handicap cards


Deal menu: This button shows a menu where you can draw situation cards and deal character and handicap cards. Note that the option may be disabled based on the state of the game, for example character cards cannot be dealt if the situation card hasn't been resolved yet.



Austrian Hand Window: This opens a window with all the Austrian cards if you play as Austria or Solo. The number to the right is the number of cards in the Austrian hand. This button is unavailable in 2- or 3-player games and in Solo CDG games.



French Hand Window: This opens a window with all the French cards if you play as France or Solo. The number to the right is the number of cards in the French hand.



Russian Hand Window: This opens a window with all the Russian cards, or coalition cards in 2- or 3-player games and in Solo CDG games, if you play as Russia, Solo or Coalition. The number to the right is the number of cards in the Russian hand.



British Hand Window: This opens a window with all the British cards if you play as Britain or Solo. The number to the right is the number of cards in the Austrian hand. This button is unavailable in 2-player games and in Solo CDG games.



Roll 1d6: Rolls a d6 and displays the result. The color of the result indicates which power made the roll



French Battle Roll: Roll 2d6 to determine a battle result.



Coalition Battle Roll: Roll 2d6 to determine a battle result.



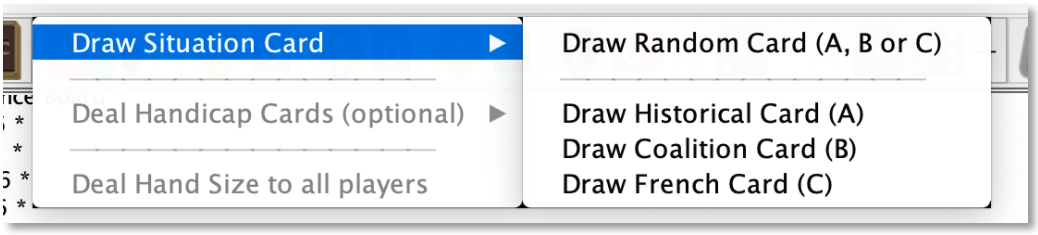
Fronts: This brings down a menu where you can choose which fronts to determine battle results. The Battle DRM track will set the pawns based on the units available in the respective armies (but nothing else such as homeland bonus or military support). Only fronts with Military Operation markers are available. The circled letter to the right shows the currently selected front.



Reset: This button resets the game in preparation of a new turn.

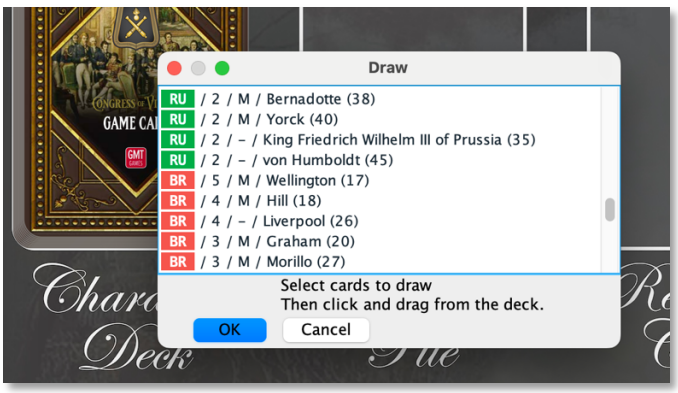
The Initial phase: Draw and resolve a Situation Card

1. Click the *Deal cards menu* button in the toolbar
2. Select *Draw Situation Card*
3. When the submenu open, select to draw a card from Deck A, B or C, or choose "Random" to draw card randomly from A, B or C
4. The card will appear just below the diplomacy issues.



The Initial phase: Deal a card to the power chosen by the Environment table roll

1. Click the *Card Window* button in the toolbar to open the card window
2. The chosen player right-clicks the deck of Character Cards and select *Draw specific card.*
3. A smaller window opens listing all cards in the deck sorted by power, strength and military capability.
4. The player marks the card they want to draw and click *Ok* to put the card in the top position in the deck
5. The player right-click the deck and select "Top card to *Power*", where *Power* corresponds to the player's power.



IMPORTANT NOTE: The list of cards shows all cards currently in deck. This may have the consequence that a card mistakenly is selected even though it is not a card belonging to the active player's power. If you're in a situation where you suspect such mistakes may occur, you can substitute point (5) above with the following



A. The player right-click the deck and select *Top card to card check*. This will move the chosen card to the (empty) Card Check Deck just below the deck of character cards.
B. Just below the Card Check Deck is a label that counts, and shows, the number of cards from a specific power in the Card Check Deck. If a card is selected within the rules, the label for the acting player's power should show "1" and all other "0".
C. When all players agree that a card was selected in lines with rules, the player right-click the Card Check Deck and select "Top card to *Power*", where *Power* corresponds to the player's power.

Character cards and card windows

Character cards are organized in three rows and when cards are dealt to the powers they will be semi sorted in these rows. The top row will contain the cards corresponding to the power. The middle and bottom rows will contain

- For **France**: Austrian and British cards in the middle, Russian and neutral in the bottom
- For **Coalition powers**: The other coalition power's cards in the middle, French and neutral in the bottom
- In **2 or 3-player** games the Coalition player will have Austrian and Russian cards in the top row, British and Neutral card in the middle and French cards in the bottom row.



French hand after receiving 15 cards

The cards can be freely moved around, and stacked, in the window.



The same hand as before but after player sorting. Row 1 & 2 contains cards usable for negotiations and debates, the 3rd row has a stack of cards that can be traded, a stack of cards to save and use as military cards, and to the far right is the card selected for Wager

Playing a character cards as wager

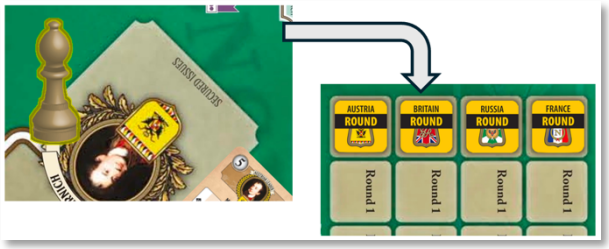
1. Right-click the card and select "Wager as *Power*", where *Power* corresponds to the player's power.
2. The card will be placed, face-down, on the negotiation table, on the selected power's diplomacy track.
3. When all powers have selected their wager card they can be flipped using the corresponding context menu option.



Note: The wager can also be performed "manually" by flipping the card and dragging it to the table.

Completing the Wager and Issue Selection

When a wager winner has been determined, move the big golden pawn to the track of the winner. You can move it anywhere on the track and I will automatically place itself at the base of the Power and move all round-markers to the correct position.



In order, players can then select the issues and drag them (or use the issue's context menu) to the negotiation table.

Negotiations and round-markers



Negotiations and debates cans start as soon as the first player moves the round-marker to indicate that round 1 has started. In general, it is good practice to update all round-markers as you go along as the game uses that to keep track of the active player. This, for example, affects the ability to trade.

Playing a card for negotiation or debate

1. Right-click a card in your hand and select *Play*
2. The card will be placed, face up, on the negotiation table.

Note: You may also just drag a card to the table.

Leader Cards

Leader cards appear in the top-left part of the hand. They cannot be played, and they do not count towards the hand size. In addition, they can be found as mini cards right by the end of the power's respective diplomacy track. Don't worry about the small size, hovering the mouse over a leader card will have a larger version pop-up. In addition, images of all leader cards can be found in the player aid.

To play a Leader you must discard another card. Right-click the card chosen for discard and select *Play for *Leader**, where **Leader** is the name of the player's leader (e.g. Napoleon). The leader and the discarded card will end up on the diplomacy table. After leader play is finished, select *Flip (Leader Used)*. This will bring the leader card back to the hand but with its backside up, indicating that it has been played. The mini card on the Diplomacy board will also have its backside up.



Trading a character card

Trading is only available to the active power, determined by the round-marker positions. As in the physical game they are treated as an agreement between the players. When a deal is concluded, and both players agree to do the trade,

1. The active player right-clicks the card chosen to trade and selects the menu option *Trade with *Power**, where *Power** corresponds to the other power in the negotiation.
2. Note that it is not possible to "Trade with…" any other power than the power corresponding to the card (which means that neutral cards doesn't have the "Trade with…" option)
3. Now, the power the active player has chosen to trade with, have the "Trade with…" card options enabled for cards belonging to the active player. When the menu option is chosen, the cards are traded and moved to the "Trade" area of each player's hand,